



Wooden Satellites

Japan plans to roll out world's first wooden satellites by 2023, in hopes of cutting down space junk. <http://digit.in/jan21-75>



RIP Periscope

Twitter's live-streaming app - Periscope, will shut down by March 2021, following a series of technical issues. <http://digit.in/jan21-76>

As I continued checking the various settings in the operating system, I noticed that the monitor was still set to 60 Hz. Not that the effects were readily apparent since we weren't running any games. But he had a decent 144 Hz panel and it was unfair to let it be. After setting the panel to 144 Hz we were nearly

done. We ran a few more benchmarks and compared the scores online to see if things were finally up to par. And then I handed the system over to my friend. I heard back from him a couple of days later as he finally saw how powerful the system actually was. I shared a few more articles on maintenance and optimisation so that

he could get some additional reading done and start troubleshooting his own problems.

We've all had a certain someone help us out with our initial PC builds and it was a wonderful experience to pay it forward. I hope given the opportunity, he does the same with someone else down the line. 

BUYING ADVICE

LAPTOP FOR ₹55K

Q Hello Agent001, I need buying advice for a gaming laptop and my budget is within ₹55K.

These are the must haves

- Intel Core i5 9th Gen or AMD equivalent
- SSD with a min capacity of 512GB or HDD/SSD combined
- 8GB RAM and 4GB graphics

At present, I am considering the Lenovo ideapad L340. But it doesn't have an SSD. Are there better ones out there?

I also would like to know whether I should buy now or wait for next year's CES or some big launch events to buy a gaming laptop.

—Alvin John

A Hey Alvin, The ₹50-55K price range is a pretty tough spot if you want both, an SSD as well as a discrete graphics card. Most laptops will either offer a discrete graphics card along with a hard drive or integrated graphics with an SSD. The latter isn't great for gaming.



Acer Nitro 5

The problem has been compounded by the fact that taxes on laptops have gone up and what could previously be obtained at ₹50-55K is now selling for ₹5-7K more. One thing that you can do is opt for the laptop with the discrete graphics which has an optional M.2 port. So that you can buy and install an SSD later. The L340 is pretty good, you can also check out the Lenovo Gaming 3i, Acer Nitro 5 and some of the ASUS TUF Gaming notebooks.

Around CES, you should see the next gen AMD Ryzen mobile CPUs so laptops will start coming in with the same. However, there's no telling which manufacturer will bring those laptops to India at the same time as overseas markets. It's more likely that we'll get them a little later. So if your need is urgent, I'd suggest picking one right away rather than waiting for the CES units. There's a good chance that we won't see them till February-March 2021.

TABLET FOR VIDEO CALLS

Q Hello, I am looking for a tablet mostly for online classes as this will be my main purpose for the purchase. I am looking for a bigger size but most tablets are around 10 inches. I was wondering if there is another device which isn't necessarily a tablet but can be used for online classes. As for other requirements, calling is optional and RAM should be at least 3 GB.

It is important to mention here that I am not looking for a laptop and my budget is around 20K.

Please, recommend a product matching my requirements and within budget.

Thank you and regards,

—Animesh Kumar

A Hey Animesh, I would suggest stretching your budget a little and getting the Lenovo P10. It's usually available for ₹21,999. The Lenovo M10 is available at ₹20K but it sports a slower SoC, Android 9 and lesser battery capacity. For the price difference between the two, the P10 is much better with the Snapdragon 450. It has 4GB of RAM so that



Lenovo Tab P10

takes care of your other criteria and it even has expandable storage so you can throw in a 256GB microSD card and get more storage. Both devices have calling built in.

Also, the choice of tablet depends on what all you are planning to study and which software you're planning to use. If you have any assignments that require the use of content creation apps, then the iPad is better designed from that perspective and also has a much more powerful SoC that's capable of providing the performance that content creation apps generally require. So I'd ask you to verify which all apps are going to be run on your tablet and then get the appropriate drive for the job. 